



What You Will Need:

Your business idea

Your most important hypothesis

The Test Card

Experiment Library

Alternatively, use your personal Project in the Strategyzer App to work in a virtual, real-time environment

Choose and Design an Experiment

In this practice you will assess your current situation in the testing process, choose an experiment for your most important hypothesis, and design it with the Test Card.

TOTAL TIME: 45 min

 Print Directions

Directions

1. Pick your most important hypothesis

In the previous lesson, you identified your most important hypothesis. This will be the hypothesis you want to test first.

2. Assess your current situation in the testing process

The experiment you choose for your most important hypothesis depends on four key factors.

DESIRABILITY FEASIBILITY VIABILITY ADAPTABILITY	Risk Category: Some experiments produce better evidence for desirability, some work better for feasibility, and some are more appropriate for viability, or adaptability.
	Journey: Depending on where you on your journey, you want to focus on testing different risk categories. During customer discovery , your goal is to test desirability, with a focus on the customer profile to better understand your customer’s jobs, pains and gains. Further evidence typically also indicates customer willingness to pay (viability), and if the market timing is right (adaptability).
	During customer validation , the evidence you want to collect should indicate that customers show interest for your product or idea (desirability, with a focus on the value proposition). You want to collect evidence for the viability of your idea by learning how much your customers are willing to pay, and the required cost structures. Technical prototypes suggest that you can manage feasibility.
	Available resources: How much money and time, and how many people do you have access to? Adjust your resources, depending on where you are on your journey from idea to successful business. Early on, you generally know little. Stick to cheap and quick experiments to pinpoint the right direction.
	Strength of Evidence: The less you know, the less you should waste time, energy, and money. When you know little, your only goal is to produce evidence that points you in the right direction. Quick and cheap experiments are most appropriate for that goal, despite the generally weak evidence. The more you know, the stronger the evidence should become, which is usually achieved by more costly and lengthier experiments.

3. Choose an experiment

Download our [Experiment Library](#) and choose an appropriate experiment. Double check if you've chosen the right experiment with these best practices:

- Go cheap and fast in the beginning.
- Always pick the experiment that produces the strongest evidence given your constraints.
- Reduce uncertainty as much as you can before you build anything.

4. Design the experiment with the Test Card

Once you've chosen the most appropriate experiment for your hypothesis, design it well with the help of the [Test Card](#).

- **Hypothesis:** Make sure your hypothesis is testable, precise and discrete.
- **Experiment:** Selecting the most appropriate experiment is just the start. Building a strong artefact will be key to strengthening your evidence, as is the right selection of participants for your experiment.
- **Metrics:** Be sure to avoid vanity metrics as well as absolute metrics whenever possible. Instead, use actionable metrics that allow you to make a decision.
- **Success Criteria:** Always set the success criteria before conducting the experiment. Do some industry or competitor research to better understand how to set your success criteria.